ChatGPT

Product Strategy and Research Blueprint for a TEDx Speaker Lifecycle Platform

Executive product thesis

The opportunity

There is a credible product opportunity here, but the strongest version of the business is **not simply a "TEDx application app."** It should be built as a broader **speaker authority operating system**, with TEDx as the initial high-intent use case.

The underlying problem is unusually fragmented. A prospective TEDx speaker currently has to move among TED's event directory, individual event websites and social accounts, application forms, documents or writing tools, research sources, public-speaking coaches, recording tools, AI speech-analysis products, calendars, social publishing tools, and personal-brand systems. There is no central TEDx application through TED, and individual volunteer-run TEDx teams independently decide whether to accept applications at all. TED specifically directs prospective speakers to locate an event, visit that event's own website or social channels, and look for a publicly posted application. If no application callout exists, the team should be treated as not accepting unsolicited pitches. [1]

That fragmentation creates the product opening.

TED reports that more than **4,000 independently organized TEDx events are held annually**, providing a substantial recurring information layer of events, dates, topics, local communities, speaker calls, and organizer-specific processes. [2]

The proposed platform should connect seven states in one persistent workspace:

Explore → Qualify → Apply → Prepare → Rehearse → Deliver → Amplify

The four user-facing pillars requested by the brief remain central:

Pillar	Core user question	Proposed product outcome
Research	"Which events are actually relevant and accepting speakers?"	A verified shortlist of legitimate, appropriate opportunities
Write	"Is my idea strong enough, and can I articulate it without turning it into a sales pitch?"	A defensible, evidence-backed idea and talk
Practice	"Can I deliver this naturally, clearly, and within the event's constraints?"	Measurable rehearsal progress and performance readiness

Pillar	Core user question	Proposed product outcome
Amplify	“How do I turn this intellectual asset into lasting authority after publication?”	An owned-media and speaking ecosystem around the idea

The most important strategic decision is that **the user's project, evidence, applications, rehearsals, and post-talk assets should persist across the entire journey**. Competitors usually solve one step. The proposed application should own the longitudinal workflow.

A crucial TEDx constraint changes the business model

TED's current rules make monetization more nuanced than an ordinary career or professional-development SaaS.

TED states that speaker selection belongs exclusively to individual TEDx teams. Speakers do not pay to speak, consideration and event-provided speaker coaching are free, and a service charging someone to “land” a TEDx talk is considered illegitimate. TED also says speaker selection should center on an original idea the person deeply understands, rather than credentials, celebrity, or professional-speaking polish. [3]

TED's organizer rules additionally prohibit commercial agendas on stage. Speakers cannot use a TEDx talk to promote their products, books, businesses, or fundraising asks. [4]

This means the app should **never** make promises such as:

- “Get booked for TEDx.”
- “Increase your TEDx acceptance probability by 300%.”
- “Exclusive access to TEDx organizers.”
- “Pay for priority consideration.”
- “Guaranteed TEDx speaker placement.”

The platform should instead describe itself as an **independent research, idea-development, communication-practice, and personal-brand product**.

It should plainly state that it is not TED or TEDx, is not affiliated with TED unless such a relationship is formally established, cannot influence speaker selection, and does not sell access to organizers.

This is more than a legal disclaimer. It should shape the product itself.

For example, when the system finds no public speaker application for an event, it should display:

> **No public speaker application detected.**
> TED asks prospective speakers not to send unsolicited pitches when an event has not publicly requested applications.

It should **not** surface scraped organizer email addresses and invite users to cold pitch them. That restraint becomes a trust feature because it follows TED's published process. [1]

Recommended positioning

A strong category statement would be:

> **A private workspace for turning expertise into stage-ready ideas, finding legitimate speaking opportunities, practicing high-stakes talks, and building long-term authority around your ideas.**

TEDx then becomes a dedicated workflow within the larger platform, rather than the entire company identity.

A neutral product brand is preferable to putting “TEDx” into the company or application name. TED maintains tightly controlled TEDx identity and branding requirements for licensed events, and its rules emphasize that TEDx events are independently organized rather than TED-operated. A product built around a third-party trademark should therefore obtain specialist trademark counsel before deciding how prominently TEDx appears in naming, advertising, metadata, or paid acquisition. [5]

Why the target customer is attractive

The proposed audience has a different set of expectations than a beginner public-speaking app user.

A coach, consultant, author, founder, researcher, executive, or established subject-matter expert is less likely to need “Public Speaking 101.” The person typically needs help with:

Opportunity intelligence. Where should I focus my limited time?

Idea clarity. Which part of my body of work is truly an idea rather than a biography, framework, service, or book pitch?

Evidence. Can the important claims survive scrutiny?

Executive-quality workflow. Can I delegate research to an assistant without handing over authorship of the idea?

Practice efficiency. Which specific parts of the talk are weakening the delivery?

Privacy. Are unreleased research, scripts, videos, and business ideas being handled appropriately?

Authority continuity. What happens after the talk?

That last point is particularly important commercially. TED discourages professional/circuit-speaker behavior in TEDx curation, and duplicate talks are not appropriate for repeated TEDx publication. A TEDx-only application would therefore have a natural retention problem. [6]

The long-term product needs to continue serving the person after TEDx through conference speaking, signature keynotes, panels, podcasts, media appearances, executive communication, thought-leadership publishing, and other high-value speaking opportunities.

TEDx should be the acquisition wedge. The durable category is authority through ideas and speaking.

Competitive landscape and market gaps

The market is split into separate product categories

Research across current products shows that the ingredients already exist, but in separate systems.

AI speaking products provide rehearsal analytics.

Speaker directories and CFP tools provide opportunities.

TED itself provides authoritative guidance and event information.

Human coaches provide high-touch strategy and editing.

Social-media software provides distribution.

What is missing is the workflow connecting them.

The following comparison is based on current publicly visible functionality and pricing as of September 2026.

Product/ category	Strongest capability	Current commercial model	What it does well	Gap relative to proposed application
TED/TEDx official ecosystem	Official event information, rules, organizer guidance, speaker preparation	Core TEDx participation is free	Authoritative rules, event framework, speaker guidance, content standards	Does not function as an individualized opportunity CRM, application workspace, longitudinal rehearsal system, or personal-brand platform. TED also has no central speaker application. [7]

Product/ category	Strongest capability	Current commercial model	What it does well	Gap relative to proposed application
Yoodli	AI communication and role-play practice	Free Starter, Pro $8/month annually, Advanced $20/month annually	Private AI practice, roleplays, recording feedback, enterprise use, security positioning	Strong practice layer, but does not solve TEDx event intelligence, application lifecycle, evidence management, or post-talk authority workflow. [8]
Orai	Individual AI speech practice	$12/month, $49.99/year, $149 lifetime	Unlimited practice in Pro, scenarios, real-time coaching, progress tracking; web and mobile access	Low-cost speech practice means generic delivery metrics alone are unlikely to support premium pricing for the proposed product. [9]
Poised	Real-time communication feedback	$19/month, or $13/month billed annually	Feedback on filler words, conciseness, hedging, interruptions and workplace communication	Primarily communication during calls and desktop meetings, rather than long-form idea development and speaker opportunity management. [10]
VirtualSpeech	Structured AI and immersive communication training	Individual plan from $45/month, enterprise and education custom	Speech practice, roleplays, scored feedback, organizational analytics, optional VR	Strong training environment but little TEDx opportunity/ application intelligence or post-publication authority management. [11]

Product/ category	Strongest capability	Current commercial model	What it does well	Gap relative to proposed application
Sessionize	Calls for speakers and event CFP management	Primarily event-organizer SaaS	Gives event organizers structured speaker submissions and gives speakers access to calls for speakers	Broad conference ecosystem rather than TEDx-specific research. Not every event is discoverable through its discovery experience, which illustrates the wider fragmentation of speaking opportunities. [12]
SpeakerMatch	Professional-speaker opportunity marketplace	Entry paid membership currently visible at $30 per 28 days	Marketplace orientation, speaker profiles and commercial speaking opportunities	Focuses on the professional speaking business, whereas TEDx selection is explicitly noncommercial and cannot be sold as paid access. [13]
eSpeakers	Speaker-business management and marketplace presence	Paid professional-speaker SaaS	Helps speakers market and manage a commercial speaking business	Better aligned to post-TEDx commercial speaking than the TEDx research and preparation process itself. [14]
Human TED-style speaking coaches	Personalized judgment and editorial support	Frequently hundreds or thousands of dollars	Deep, contextual critique and accountability	Expensive, capacity-constrained, difficult to standardize, often disconnected from structured event intelligence and software analytics. Current coaching offers show substantial willingness to pay for high-touch application/talk support. [15]

Product/ category	Strongest capability	Current commercial model	What it does well	Gap relative to proposed application
Buffer and social-management tools	Publishing and scheduling	Freemium	Buffer's free tier supports up to three social channels and up to 10 scheduled posts per channel, and its API supports third-party scheduling integrations	Useful after a talk but has no understanding of a speaker's talk thesis, evidence, applications or rehearsal history. [16]

The conclusion is not that the market lacks speech software. It has plenty.

The gap is **contextual continuity**.

The largest competitive gaps

Fragmented opportunity discovery is the clearest initial wedge.

TED itself explains that there is no centralized TEDx speaker application. A user must find events and then inspect each event's own site or social media for a public application. Most teams find speakers by researching their own communities rather than through an open call. [1]

That creates a genuinely useful research product:

> “Show me relevant licensed events, whether they are publicly accepting speaker applications, exactly where that status was verified, when it was last checked, and why the event may or may not fit my idea.”

That is much more valuable than another list of TEDx event names.

The second gap is idea-first matching.

Most opportunity marketplaces optimize around a speaker's profile: expertise, fee, topic, availability and credentials. TED tells its organizers and prospective speakers to focus on the **idea**, not the person's status or polished speaker profile. [1]

The proposed app can therefore match:

Idea → event

rather than merely:

Speaker profile → event

That produces a differentiated data model.

The third gap is TEDx-aware content risk analysis.

TED's current content rules prohibit selling from the stage and include restrictions around political and religious agendas. TED also requires credible support for scientific claims and warns against poor science and unsupported assertions. [17]

A generic AI writing product does not know the difference between compelling personal-brand copy and content that could create a TEDx compliance issue.

The product can.

The fourth gap is evidence management.

A high-authority speaker may make claims about health, economics, psychology, technology, management, education, climate, social science, or business. TED's organizer guidance emphasizes fact-checking empirical claims. [18]

The app could make every substantive claim an object with:

```
Claim → source → evidence strength → citation → reviewer status → script location
```

That is considerably more useful than asking an LLM, “Is my TEDx speech good?”

The fifth gap is authentic AI assistance.

This requires particular care.

TEDx events are independently managed, so organizer policies can differ. For example, TEDxAtlanta's published speaker application information has required applicants to affirm that their submitted content was not AI-generated. [19]

A product that automatically generates “winning TEDx answers” could therefore create exactly the wrong behavior.

The stronger design is an **AI thought partner rather than default AI ghostwriter**.

The system asks questions, identifies unclear logic, highlights repetition, surfaces possible commerciality, finds unsupported claims, compares versions, and gives critique. The speaker remains the author.

The sixth gap is the transition from stage performance to authority asset.

Current rehearsal apps largely stop when the presentation is delivered. Social publishing platforms start only after content exists.

The proposed system already knows:

- the user's expertise,
- the thesis,
- the stories,
- the evidence,
- the memorable phrases,
- the approved biography,
- the audience,
- the talk structure,
- the public-speaking goals,
- the media assets,
- and eventually the publication link.

That data can become the foundation for a highly personalized post-talk authority campaign.

Competitive moat

The AI model itself is not a durable moat. Speech transcription, text generation and basic vocal analytics are increasingly accessible.

The defensibility would need to come from a proprietary workflow and data layer.

Potential moat	Why it matters
Normalized opportunity history	Records which events had public applications, previous deadlines, themes, questions, policies, and status changes
Source-backed application status	Trust increases when every “Open,” “Closed,” or “No public call detected” label has a source and verification date
Idea and evidence graph	Connects a person's expertise, claims, research and speaking assets across multiple talks
Longitudinal rehearsal data	Shows how a speaker changes across drafts and performances rather than grading one isolated recording
TEDx-specific content-risk engine	Encodes relevant public rules and organizer-specific constraints rather than generic presentation advice
Human coach collaboration layer	Combines AI pattern detection with expert judgment without depending entirely on one-to-one coaching
Post-talk authority history	Connects a talk with later speaking inquiries, media appearances, content and commercial outcomes

Potential moat	Why it matters
Organizer-verified opportunity data	A future free organizer portal could improve data quality without selling influence over selection

The product should **not** make acceptance prediction its moat.

There will not be a clean, representative label set for “why a person was rejected,” because TEDx teams curate independently. An “82% likelihood of acceptance” score would therefore create false precision and could conflict with the idea-first, local, independent nature of TEDx curation. [1]

A transparent **Fit Score** is much safer.

For example:

Fit component	Suggested weight
Public application and explicit eligibility	30%
Local/community relationship	20%
Event theme and topic alignment	20%
Idea differentiation	15%
Evidence readiness	10%
Timing and practical availability	5%

The interface should call this:

Opportunity Fit: 84/100

not:

Acceptance Probability: 84%.

Every dimension should be expandable so the user sees the reasoning.

Product experience and feature architecture

Core information architecture

A clean primary navigation could be:

Navigation area	Purpose
Home	Next actions and lifecycle status

Navigation area	Purpose
Opportunities	Event and speaking-opportunity intelligence
Ideas & Talks	Idea development, applications, script and evidence
Practice Lab	Recording, analysis and rehearsal planning
Amplify	Post-talk distribution and authority assets
Evidence Vault	Research, claims, citations and permissions
Team	Assistant, editor, coach or collaborator access
Settings	Data, privacy, integrations and billing

Rather than presenting four unrelated tools, Home should display a milestone journey.

For example:

> **Current stage: Researching**
> Idea readiness: 72%
> Qualified opportunities: 6
> Public applications open: 2
> Next deadline: 19 days
> Recommended next action: Resolve two evidence gaps before completing Application A

After selection, the interface changes:

> **Current stage: Preparing**
> Event date: 84 days away
> Draft stage: Second revision
> Unsupported claims: 1
> Full-length rehearsals completed: 3
> Next official checkpoint: Script review Friday

After publication:

> **Current stage: Amplifying**
> Official talk published
> Launch campaign: 8/14 actions complete
> Speaking-page visits: 482
> Inbound inquiries attributed: 4

The product therefore feels like one guided project rather than a collection of AI buttons.

Research pillar: Opportunity Intelligence

This should be the strongest launch feature.

Each event record should contain:

Data field	Example
Event name	TEDxExampleCity
TED.com verification	Verified
Location	City, country
Event date	Exact or pending
Event type	Standard, University, Women, Youth, etc.
Official TED page	Source record
Organizer site	Source record
Public speaker application	Open / Closed / Not detected / Unknown
Application URL	Verified source
Deadline	Date and timezone
Last verification	Timestamp
Theme	Text
Local relationship expectation	Explicit / implied / unknown
Application questions	Structured fields
Intro-video requirement	Yes / no
Selection timeline	If publicly listed
AI policy	Allowed / restricted / prohibited / unknown
Application contact policy	Public call only / nomination / unknown
Past talk topics	Searchable taxonomy
Notes	Human-verified observations
Confidence	High / medium / low

The most important design element is **source provenance**.

A deadline should never appear simply as:

> October 15

It should appear as:

October 15, 2026
Verified September 21, 2026
Source: Organizer's speaker application page

The source hierarchy should be:

Tier A: TED.com for licensed event existence and official event details.

Tier B: Organizer-controlled website or application form for speaker application status.

Tier C: Organizer's verified social channels.

Tier D: Community/user submission awaiting review.

TED's own instructions make this data hierarchy necessary because application status frequently lives outside TED.com. [1]

A data-quality operations queue should flag:

- application deadline passed but page still says “apply now,”
- conflicting dates,
- broken application form,
- event date changed,
- social post newer than website,
- unclear local eligibility,
- newly detected application,
- application removed,
- organizer page inaccessible.

This is not merely back-office work. **Data freshness is part of the core product.**

The opportunity interface should offer saved searches such as:

Within 250 miles
Applications currently open
Topic alignment above 70
Deadline more than 30 days away
No detected AI-content prohibition
Events related to healthcare and human performance

Users should be able to **watch** an event even if applications are closed.

The product then notifies them when:

- a new public application appears,
- a deadline is announced,

- a theme is published,
- the deadline changes,
- a previously open call closes.

TED reports more than 4,000 annual TEDx events, so users need filtering and monitoring rather than an unstructured global list. [2]

Application CRM

Each opportunity should move through a simple pipeline:

`Watching → Qualified → Preparing → Submitted → Interview/Conversation → Selected → Not selected → Archived`

For each active application, the workspace stores:

- application questions,
- the user's responses,
- revisions,
- video requirements,
- submission deadline,
- proof of submission,
- follow-up dates,
- event communication,
- relevant idea version,
- sources used in the application.

The product should explicitly discourage mass submission. TED says one clear genuine pitch is sufficient and advises against unsolicited outreach when an event has not requested applications. [1]

That creates a useful product principle:

> **Quality of fit over quantity of applications.**

Writing pillar: Idea and Talk Studio

The writing system should not begin with “Generate my TEDx speech.”

It should begin with **Idea Thesis**.

A structured idea canvas could ask:

Question	Purpose
What is the idea in one sentence?	Forces conceptual clarity

Question	Purpose
What does your audience probably believe now?	Defines current mental model
What are you asking them to see differently?	Establishes change in perspective
Why are you qualified to know this?	Establishes firsthand expertise without centering credentials
What evidence supports it?	Builds defensibility
What evidence challenges it?	Reduces overclaiming
What part is genuinely new?	Tests differentiation
Why does it matter beyond your personal story?	Prevents biography-only talks
What should the audience understand at the end?	Clarifies outcome
What are you explicitly **not** selling?	Prevents commercial drift

This directly matches TED's published emphasis on ideas rather than profiles and on original ideas that speakers know deeply. [1]

Idea Overlap Explorer

The user enters a thesis.

The system semantically searches the TED/TEDx corpus and related sources and returns:

Related talks
Similar concepts
Common arguments
Areas of potential overlap
Possible differentiation questions

It should **not** announce “Your idea is 94% original.” Semantic similarity cannot prove intellectual originality.

Better language:

“We found several conceptually related talks. Review these before claiming novelty.”

TEDx Content Guard

The platform should examine a draft for risk categories grounded in public TED/TEDx rules:

Risk area	Example signal
Commercial agenda	Repeated company/product/book mentions
Call to purchase	“Enroll,” “buy,” “hire us,” discount or URL
Funding ask	Investment or donation solicitation
Political advocacy	Candidate/party promotion or campaigning
Religious advocacy	Proselytizing or claims requiring religious acceptance
Weak science	Strong causal claim with poor or absent evidence
Anecdote overreach	Personal experience presented as universal proof
Unsupported statistic	Numerical claim with no source
Copyright	Image, chart or media with unclear rights
Overclaiming	“This always works,” “proves,” “guarantees”

TED's current content guidelines expressly address commercial agendas, politics, religion and weak science. [17]

The software should call these **risk flags**, not determinations.

For example:

> **Commerciality risk: Medium**
> Your company name appears six times in the talk. TED's rules prohibit using the stage to pitch a business. Consider keeping only the reference necessary to establish context.

That is much safer than:

> “Your talk is TED-approved.”

Only the organizer and TED's processes can determine actual compliance.

Evidence Ledger

Every empirical statement can be highlighted and converted into a claim:

> “Remote employees are 23% more productive.”

The system then asks:

- What is the source?
- Is it primary or secondary?
- What population was studied?

- When was it published?
- Is the claim causal or correlational?
- Is the wording stronger than the evidence?
- Does a competing source exist?
- Has a human reviewed this claim?

Status might be:

```
Unverified → Source attached → Evidence checked → Wording aligned → Approved
```

TED's organizer material places explicit importance on fact-checking empirical claims, which makes this feature unusually well matched to the use case. [18]

Talk Structure Workspace

Instead of forcing one storytelling formula, give speakers flexible building blocks:

```
Opening → Problem/Tension → Idea → Evidence → Illustration → Implication → Application → Closing
```

Each block displays:

- estimated delivery time,
- words,
- evidence dependencies,
- visual dependencies,
- speaker notes,
- current draft status.

TED's current organizer preparation guidance emphasizes a clear introduction, middle and ending, brevity, purpose, audience relevance, and focus around a major idea. [20]

Version control

A high-authority speaker may make dozens of substantial revisions. The platform should offer:

- named versions,
- automatic snapshots,
- sentence-level comparison,
- restored versions,
- coach comments,
- “accepted/rejected suggestion” history,
- current word count,
- estimated runtime by speaker's actual measured pace.

The last feature is better than a generic words-per-minute calculator.

After several rehearsals, the system knows:

> At your natural stage pace, this 2,240-word draft is estimated at 16:42.

That estimation improves from the user's own performance history.

Slide review

TED's speaker-preparation material advises restraint with slides, including avoiding crowded slides and ensuring each slide has a purpose. It also requires speakers to manage appropriate rights to third-party visual material. [20]

A slide analyzer can therefore check:

- excessive words,
- tiny text,
- duplicate information,
- slide density,
- unnecessary slides,
- suspiciously low-resolution visuals,
- missing source attribution,
- missing rights confirmation.

Practice pillar: Rehearsal Lab

Public-speaking AI is already crowded, so basic filler-word counting cannot be the differentiator.

Yoodli already offers AI roleplays and recording feedback at $8 to $20 per month billed annually. Orai offers unlimited Pro practice for $12 monthly or $49.99 annually. Poised offers real-time professional communication feedback at $19 monthly or $13 monthly when billed annually. [21]

The proposed platform therefore needs **talk-specific rehearsal intelligence**.

A recording report should include:

Dimension	Measurement
Duration	Total and section-by-section
Pace	Words per minute over time
Pause behavior	Number, length and placement
Filler frequency	Per minute and by phrase
Repetition	Repeated clauses and concepts
Verbal hedging	“Maybe,” “sort of,” “I think,” etc.

Dimension	Measurement
Volume consistency	Quiet/loud periods
Cadence variability	Vocal variation over time
Opening stability	Variation between rehearsal openings
Closing stability	Variation between rehearsal closings
Section recall	Missing or reordered idea blocks
Script deviation	Meaningful deviations from current draft
Evidence accuracy	Numbers/claims misstated during delivery
Runtime variance	Consistency across full runs
Movement	Optional stage-position/motion analysis
Eye line	Optional camera-based analysis

The system should avoid questionable “emotion recognition” scores such as “73% confident” based on facial expression. Objective behavioral signals are easier to explain and defend.

TEDx-specific rehearsal rubric

The platform's coaching layer can evaluate:

- Is the central idea still understandable when spoken aloud?
- Does the introduction reach the idea quickly enough?
- Does storytelling support the idea or replace it?
- Are evidence and anecdotes clearly distinguished?
- Are claims delivered with appropriate certainty?
- Does any section sound like a commercial pitch?
- Does the speaker sound memorized rather than conversational?
- Is the closing a natural consequence of the idea?
- Has the talk stayed within the assigned event time?
- Are slides being used as support rather than teleprompter material?

TED's organizer guidance emphasizes starting rehearsal early, recording and reviewing practice, conversational delivery, managing body movement, and conducting a dress rehearsal. Its sample preparation process can begin many months before the event, with increasingly frequent rehearsals as the date approaches. [22]

That allows the product to create a dynamic rehearsal schedule.

Example:

> **Event in 11 weeks**
> This week: two section rehearsals, one full run

Next week: one coach review, two full runs
Final month: weekly full-length checkpoint
Final week: stage-condition rehearsal
Final 48 hours: dress-rehearsal checklist

Compare Runs

This could become one of the most useful premium experiences.

Instead of:

Filler words: 13

show:

Run 5 vs. Run 1
Duration: 17:31 → 15:58
Filler words/minute: 2.1 → 0.9
Opening variation: high → low
Unsupported claim deviations: 3 → 0
Section 4 pace: still 18% faster than personal baseline
Closing pause: improved by 1.7 seconds
Repeated phrase “what I realized was”: still present four times

That creates visible progress.

Practice modes

The system should include:

Mode	Purpose
Section drill	Rehearse one difficult segment
Full run	Deliver without interruption
Opening drill	Repeat first minute until stable
Closing drill	Strengthen ending
Random restart	Start from a randomly selected idea block
No-script run	Test conceptual recall
Distraction run	Simulate imperfect conditions
Camera run	Optimize recorded/video delivery
Stage run	Wide-frame movement feedback

Mode	Purpose
Dress rehearsal	Full conditions, clothes, slides and timing

Human feedback

The best long-term product is likely hybrid AI plus human review.

However, because TED explicitly states that speakers should not pay to obtain TEDx speaking opportunities and its rules around paid TEDx coaching are sensitive, the company should obtain specialist counsel and ideally written clarification before selling any service marketed specifically as paid TEDx coaching. [23]

A particularly cautious product design would provide a **Selected TEDx Speaker Mode** in which TEDx-specific preparation features remain available at no additional charge and prominently direct the speaker to the event's own coaching process. TED's official organizer guidance requires substantial speaker preparation, and TEDx teams are expected to guide selected speakers through that process. [20]

Human paid coaching can safely remain a broader “keynote and professional speaking” business line until the TEDx-specific commercial boundaries are confirmed.

Marketing pillar: Authority Amplification

This area should be designed around a key distinction:

Selling from the TEDx stage is prohibited. Building your professional brand around your expertise outside the stage is a separate activity.

TED's content rules prohibit pitches for the speaker's business, products, books or funding during the talk. [17]

The product should therefore actively separate:

Talk Content

from:

Post-Talk Business Development

That separation is useful both ethically and strategically.

The amplification workflow begins only when appropriate.

Pre-publication mode

Before an official video is available:

- finalize speaker bio,
- prepare owned-media profiles,
- create media contacts,
- plan publication-day communications,
- prepare newsletter framework,
- prepare noncommercial event recap,
- create personal website talk page as a draft,
- build post-publication campaign calendar.

Published mode

Once the official publication exists:

- store official talk link,
- embed rather than automatically copy the video where appropriate,
- create campaign URLs with tracking parameters,
- create talk landing page,
- create speaker one-sheet,
- generate social content from the speaker's own thesis and materials,
- create newsletter sequence,
- create article outline,
- create podcast pitch angles,
- create press angles,
- create panel topics,
- create keynote expansion ideas,
- collect audience and media reactions,
- monitor inbound speaking inquiries.

TEDx speakers sign a speaker release, and recorded-talk distribution rights are governed by that arrangement. The amplification system should therefore avoid automatically downloading, clipping or redistributing official TEDx footage unless the necessary rights are clearly available. [24]

Do not build a social scheduler in the MVP.

Buffer already provides multichannel scheduling, a free plan supporting up to three channels with up to 10 scheduled posts per channel at a time, and an API for integrations. [16]

The proposed platform should own the **strategy and content intelligence**, then hand publishing to Buffer or another scheduling integration.

That keeps engineering focused on differentiated value.

A campaign generated from one talk might include:

Asset	Goal
Official-talk landing page	Central authority asset
LinkedIn launch post	Initial professional reach
Five idea posts	Extend thesis over several weeks
Newsletter	Reach owned audience
Long-form article	Expand argument beyond talk constraints
Speaker one-sheet	Convert visibility into opportunities
Podcast pitch	Expand reach through interviews
Media pitch	Earned coverage
Signature keynote outline	Convert idea into broader speaking asset
FAQ article	Address questions that did not fit talk
Research/resource page	Strengthen subject-matter credibility

The product should measure downstream outcomes, not vanity alone:

`Talk visit → profile visit → inquiry → qualified speaking lead → booked opportunity`

This gives the user a business reason to keep paying after the TEDx lifecycle ends.

Freemium business model and monetization

Pricing must reflect both competition and TEDx rules

The public-speaking AI category places strong downward pressure on the price of basic rehearsal analytics. Current individual plans include Yoodli Pro at $8 per month billed annually, Yoodli Advanced at $20, Orai at $12 monthly or $49.99 annually, Poised at $19 monthly or $13 on an annual basis, and VirtualSpeech's individual offering from $45 monthly. [25]

Therefore:

> **“AI speech feedback” cannot justify the premium by itself.**

The premium is justified by combining:

opportunity intelligence + workflow + evidence + talk development + advanced practice + collaboration + authority amplification.

The recommended pricing below should initially be treated as a **pricing hypothesis**, then tested through interviews, concierge pilots and live checkout experiments.

Tier	Suggested price	Core customer	Proposed inclusions
Free	$0	Expert exploring speaking	TEDx public opportunity search, limited watchlist, one Idea Canvas, basic compliance checks, application status tracking, limited recording analysis, official-guidance links
Authority Pro	**$29/month or $249/year**	Individual expert or thought leader	Full opportunity monitoring, broader speaking-opportunity intelligence, multiple talk projects, evidence ledger, advanced rehearsal analytics, version history, advanced authority campaigns, integrations, exports
Authority Studio	**$79/month or $699/year**	Executive + assistant/brand manager	Everything in Pro, several collaborators, advanced permissions, review workflows, brand asset library, private team comments, reporting
Coach/ Agency	**$149/month starting point**	Communication coach or boutique agency	Multi-client workspaces, client templates, review dashboards, shared rubrics, white-label reports where legally appropriate
Enterprise	Custom	Leadership development programs	SSO, administration, analytics, custom retention, security review, organizational templates and support

What should remain free

The free tier cannot be a useless demo.

A good free experience should let the user experience one complete loop:

Find a legitimate opportunity → clarify an idea → prepare an application workspace → record a rehearsal → receive useful feedback.

Proposed free allowances:

Feature	Free allowance
Authority profile	1
TEDx research access	Core access
Saved opportunities	5

Feature	Free allowance
Active TEDx application workspaces	1
Idea canvases	1
Evidence claims	15
Talk projects	1
Practice analysis	3 sessions/month or capped minutes
Basic content-risk scan	Included
Basic deadline reminders	Included
Post-talk campaign	Basic checklist
Export	Basic PDF/text

A core compliance principle should be:

> **The free tier must never intentionally hide information required to determine whether an event is publicly accepting applications.**

Selling the existence of a public application as secret “insider access” would be strategically and ethically poor positioning.

What customers pay for

Premium value should primarily be **depth, productivity, scale, privacy and continuity**.

For example:

Advanced research

- unlimited watches,
- cross-event comparison,
- deeper semantic fit analysis,
- historical application-window patterns,
- custom searches,
- advanced alerts,
- broader conference/podcast/panel database.

Advanced writing

- unlimited talk projects,
- semantic overlap exploration,
- full evidence ledger,
- script comparisons,

- collaborator workflows,
- advanced source management.

Advanced practice

- larger analysis allowance,
- compare-runs dashboard,
- talk-specific section analytics,
- movement analysis,
- long-term performance trends,
- executive private-storage controls.

Advanced amplification

- campaign generation,
- brand voice profiles,
- media kit,
- speaker one-sheet,
- inquiry attribution,
- website/export integrations,
- content-calendar integrations.

The crucial retention strategy

A subscription limited to “getting ready for one TEDx” has a structural churn problem.

A successful user's reason to use it disappears.

The product should therefore expand naturally:

TEDx

↓

Other idea-driven conferences

↓

Professional keynotes

↓

Panels and fireside chats

↓

Podcasts and media interviews

↓

Executive presentations

↓

Ongoing thought leadership

The user's original Idea Graph can continue producing opportunities.

For example, after a TEDx talk about workplace loneliness:

> **Related opportunity detected**
> Future of Work Summit
> Panel topic: Social Connection in Hybrid Organizations
> Fit: 91/100
> Public CFP closes in 23 days

This turns the platform from a one-project tool into an ongoing professional asset.

Monetization boundaries

The following distinction should be encoded into product policy:

Monetize	Do not monetize
General professional speaking education	TEDx speaker placement
Advanced public opportunity research	Private access to TEDx organizers
AI rehearsal analytics	“Guaranteed acceptance”
General idea development	Pay-to-pitch arrangements
Evidence management	Paid influence over TEDx selection
Brand management	Selling TEDx organizer contact databases for cold outreach
Post-talk professional development	Misleading “official TEDx coach” positioning
Broader speaking opportunity intelligence	Preferential TEDx application treatment

This is one of the areas where legal review is necessary before launch, particularly around use of TED/TEDx marks and paid TEDx-specific coaching features. TED's current speaker guidance is unusually explicit that speaking opportunities cannot be sold and that paid services claiming to land TEDx talks are illegitimate. [3]

Expansion revenue

Once product-market fit is established, several additional revenue channels become plausible without depending on TEDx placement.

Professional opportunity intelligence. Add conferences, associations, professional organizations, panels, media opportunities and podcasts.

Team accounts. A CEO may have an executive assistant, chief of staff, communications lead and outside coach involved in preparation.

Coach SaaS. Coaches manage multiple speaker workspaces.

Enterprise leadership development. Companies can use the Practice Lab for internal presentations, executive communication and leadership development. The existence of team-focused offerings from Yoodli and VirtualSpeech demonstrates established demand for AI-supported communication training in organizations. [26]

Professional media kit hosting. Persistent speaker pages and inquiry tracking.

Premium research intelligence. Historical opportunity trends and personalized broader speaking recommendations.

General keynote review services. Human experts review professional speaking material separate from prohibited pay-for-TEDx placement arrangements.

Technical architecture, AI design, privacy and trust

Recommended architecture

This product is technically feasible as a responsive web application. A native mobile application is not required for the MVP.

Current web standards provide browser APIs for requesting local audio/video streams and recording those media streams. W3C's Media Capture specification defines browser access to local audio and video, while MediaStream Recording defines the recording interface. [27]

A practical initial architecture is:

```
Responsive Web Client
        ↓
Application/API Layer
        ↓
PostgreSQL + Search
        ↓
```

```
Object Storage for Audio/Video
        ↓
Background Job Queue
        ↓
Transcription + Metric Processing
        ↓
AI Coaching and Evidence Services
        ↓
Structured Feedback Results
```

The MVP should begin as a **modular monolith**, not dozens of microservices.

The domains can still be clearly separated in code:

```
Identity
Profiles
Events
Opportunities
Applications
Ideas
Talks
Evidence
Rehearsals
Coaching
Campaigns
Billing
Notifications
Integrations
```

Services can be separated later when scale or team ownership creates a real need.

Recommended core data model

A simplified relational model could contain:

```
User
Organization
Membership

AuthorityProfile
ExpertiseArea
Idea
IdeaVersion

Event
```

```
EventSource
Opportunity
OpportunityStatus
ApplicationRequirement
ApplicationQuestion
ApplicationSubmission

TalkProject
TalkSection
ScriptVersion
Slide
Claim
EvidenceSource
ClaimReview

RehearsalSession
Transcript
TranscriptSegment
SpeechMetric
RehearsalComparison
CoachComment

Campaign
CampaignAsset
DistributionChannel
TrackedLink
InboundInquiry

Integration
Consent
AuditEvent
BillingAccount
```

A particularly important relationship is:

```
AuthorityProfile
   ↓
Idea
   ↓
Opportunity
   ↓
Application
   ↓
TalkProject
   ↓
Claims + Evidence
```

```
   ↓
Rehearsals
   ↓
Published Asset
   ↓
Campaign
   ↓
Speaking Inquiries
```

That graph is the actual product.

Event data ingestion

The event intelligence pipeline deserves first-class engineering and operations investment.

A suggested process:

```
TED event discovery
      ↓
Canonical event record
      ↓
Organizer website discovery
      ↓
Application/status extraction
      ↓
Structured normalization
      ↓
Conflict detection
      ↓
Human QA where needed
      ↓
Last-verified timestamp
      ↓
User alerts
```

The product should not blindly trust an LLM extraction.

For each important field store:

```
value
source
source_type
retrieved_at
confidence
```

```
verified_by
verification_method
```

Example:

```
application_status = "OPEN"
source_type = "ORGANIZER_WEBSITE"
retrieved_at = "2026-09-21T18:44:00Z"
confidence = 0.97
verified_by = "AUTOMATED+HUMAN"
```

This enables a defensible UI:

> **Application: OPEN**
> High-confidence verification
> Checked 6 hours ago

For an ambiguous case:

> **Application status: UNKNOWN**
> We found an older speaker page but cannot confirm that it applies to the upcoming event.

That is much better than hallucinating an opportunity.

AI architecture

AI should be separated into distinct tasks rather than one general chatbot.

Opportunity Extraction Model

Input: event page.

Output: date, application state, deadline, theme, criteria, application questions, AI policy and source snippets.

Opportunity Fit Engine

Input: structured event + Authority Profile + idea.

Output: dimension scores and explanation.

It should use a combination of deterministic rules and semantic scoring.

A hard rule such as “public application closed” should outrank semantic similarity.

Idea Coach

Asks Socratic questions rather than automatically replacing the user's idea.

Content Risk Analyzer

Returns structured findings:

```
{
  "category": "commerciality",
  "severity": "medium",
  "text_range": "...",
  "reason": "...",
  "suggested_question": "Can the company reference be removed without weakening
the idea?"
}
```

Claim Extractor

Identifies empirical claims requiring evidence.

Evidence Assistant

Retrieves and organizes sources but never quietly changes an unverified claim into a fact.

Speech Analytics Engine

Calculates objective metrics from timestamped transcripts and audio signals.

Talk Coach

Combines:

- current script,
- transcript,
- prior rehearsals,
- user's goals,
- metric deltas,
- event constraints,

to provide contextual feedback.

Amplification Assistant

Uses the user's own ideas, thesis and approved materials to generate post-talk content plans.

AI authorship controls

This is important enough to be a product-level capability.

Give users two modes:

Coach Mode

> Ask questions, critique, identify weaknesses, suggest options. Do not write final application answers or final speech language.

Draft Mode

> Generate editable material where permitted.

Each opportunity can carry:

```
AI Policy: Allowed / Restricted / Prohibited / Unknown
```

If an organizer prohibits AI-generated application content, Draft Mode should automatically disable inside that event's application workspace.

A message could say:

> **This organizer has published an AI-content restriction.**
> Coach Mode remains available for questions and feedback, but the application answers must be authored by you.

TEDxAtlanta provides a concrete example of why organizer-level AI policy tracking is necessary. [19]

The platform should also maintain an optional **Authorship Log**:

> User-authored characters: 91%
> AI-generated text inserted: 0%
> AI critique sessions: 12
> External editor changes: 4

That could become valuable to users working under strict authorship policies.

Browser recording and processing

A web-first recording workflow can be:

```
Camera/microphone permission → browser recording → chunked upload → encrypted object storage → async transcription → analysis → report
```

W3C's recording specification explicitly supports time-sliced recording and notes that excessive buffering can consume browser resources. Chunked uploads are therefore the sensible implementation for longer rehearsal recordings. [28]

This architecture avoids blocking the user's browser while speech analysis runs.

A user should be able to close the rehearsal page after successful upload and later see the completed analysis.

Data privacy

Privacy is particularly important for the target market because users may upload:

- unreleased book concepts,
- unpublished research,
- confidential company stories,
- future product ideas,
- proprietary frameworks,
- private client anecdotes,
- personal stories,
- unreleased speeches,
- audio and video of themselves.

Yoodli already markets SOC 2 Type 2 certification and GDPR compliance, which establishes a meaningful competitive benchmark for a communication product seeking professional and enterprise buyers. [29]

Recommended defaults include:

No customer-content training by default.

Users should not discover that their unreleased talk was used to improve a general model.

Explicit media retention controls.

For example:

> Delete raw recording after analysis
> Keep 30 days
> Keep until I delete it

Separate media and application metadata permissions.

A collaborator may be allowed to comment on a script without seeing every application or business asset.

Export and deletion.

Users need straightforward project export and account deletion.

Encryption.

TLS in transit, encrypted persistent storage, and secrets managed outside application code.

Audit history.

Especially for team accounts:

> Assistant edited deadline
> Coach commented on Section 4
> Speaker approved Draft 7
> User exported transcript

Redaction tools.

A speaker discussing a client should be able to tag a name as confidential and replace it consistently.

AI regulation and transparency

If launched in the European Union, product design should account for the AI Act. As of August 2, 2026, new AI transparency provisions are in effect, including obligations related to making people aware when they are interacting directly with an AI system in covered circumstances. [30]

The simplest product posture is transparent everywhere:

> **AI Coach**

rather than trying to make an automated agent appear human.

The product should also visibly distinguish:

`System measurement`

from:

`AI inference`

from:

`Human coach feedback`.

For example:

Speaking pace: **142 WPM**
Calculated from transcript timing

versus:

Central idea clarity: **Needs review**
AI coaching assessment

This distinction improves trust.

Build versus integrate

Capability	Recommendation
Event normalization	**Build**
Fit scoring	**Build**
Application CRM	**Build**
Idea and evidence graph	**Build**
Script/version workspace	**Build**
TEDx-aware risk engine	**Build**
Talk-specific rehearsal analytics	**Build**
Raw speech-to-text model	Buy/API initially
Foundation LLM	Buy/API with abstraction layer
Email delivery	Integrate
Calendar	Integrate
Payment processing	Integrate
Social scheduling	Integrate, do not build first
Video storage	Cloud object storage
Generic authentication	Integrate/library
General analytics	Integrate
VR stage simulation	Defer

A proprietary transcription model would add enormous effort while providing little initial differentiation.

The unique asset is what the application does **after transcription**.

Product roadmap, validation, go-to-market and operating metrics

MVP scope

A credible first release does not need every feature described above.

The recommended MVP is built around one complete outcome:

> **Help a credible expert discover appropriate public TEDx opportunities, develop an idea responsibly, manage an application, and begin meaningful practice.**

The following scope is sufficient.

Priority	Capability	Why it belongs in MVP
P0	Account and Authority Profile	Personalization foundation
P0	Verified event/opportunity database	Primary acquisition wedge
P0	Search, filter and watchlists	Turns raw event data into value
P0	Source-backed application status	Establishes trust
P0	Deadline alerts	High practical value
P0	Application CRM	Creates recurring workflow
P0	Idea Thesis Canvas	Enforces idea-first positioning
P0	Basic TEDx Content Guard	Meaningful differentiation
P0	Script editor and versions	Connects idea to rehearsal
P0	Claim/Evidence Ledger Lite	Supports TED fact-checking expectations
P0	Browser recording	Core practice input
P0	Transcript, duration, pace, fillers, pauses	Useful baseline feedback
P0	Project progress page	Ties lifecycle together
P0	Freemium billing	Validates business model
P1	Advanced semantic fit	Improve research quality
P1	Compare rehearsals	Strong premium value
P1	Full evidence research workflow	Deepens differentiation
P1	Team collaboration	High-authority user requirement
P1	Amplification workspace	Extends retention
P1	Buffer/calendar integrations	Saves manual work

Priority	Capability	Why it belongs in MVP
P2	Optional movement analysis	Delivery depth
P2	Coach multi-client accounts	B2B expansion
P2	Organizer claim portal	Data network effect
P2	Broader speaking-opportunity database	Reduces TEDx dependence
P2	Enterprise administration	Later revenue expansion
P3	VR practice	Expensive and unnecessary for validation

What should explicitly not be in MVP

Do not build:

Automatic TEDx application submission.
It encourages volume and reduces intentionality.

Cold-email automation to organizers.
It conflicts with TED guidance when no public application exists. [1]

Acceptance probability.
The data cannot justify it.

A full social scheduling platform.
Existing products already solve it. [31]

VR.
VirtualSpeech already demonstrates the category, but web recording provides far more value per engineering dollar for the initial product. [32]

A generic AI chatbot as the main interface.
The product advantage comes from structured workflows, not chat.

Automatic complete talk generation.
It undermines authenticity and creates organizer-policy risk.

A paid TEDx organizer marketplace.
This would run directly into the independence and pay-to-speak concerns in TED's rules. [33]

Suggested build sequence

Assuming a small experienced team, an indicative program could look like this. These timelines are planning estimates, not external benchmarks.

Period	Work
Discovery, roughly 4 weeks	Interviews, workflow research, legal/trademark review, event-data prototype
Foundation, roughly 4 to 6 weeks	Identity, profiles, database, event ingestion, search, application CRM
Talk workspace, roughly 4 weeks	Idea Canvas, script versions, compliance checks, evidence model
Practice, roughly 4 weeks	Browser capture, upload, transcription, basic speech metrics
Paid beta, roughly 2 to 4 weeks	Billing, usage limits, analytics, QA, lifecycle onboarding
Post-beta	Compare runs, team collaboration, amplification, broader opportunities

A focused MVP is therefore roughly a **four to five month product effort** for a capable small team, with event data operations running in parallel. A narrower concierge MVP can be tested earlier.

Initial team

A lean team could consist of:

Role	Suggested allocation
Founder/Product Lead	1
Product Designer/Researcher	1
Full-stack engineers	2
Backend/AI engineer	1
Data/research operations	0.5 to 1
QA	Part-time initially
Legal/privacy/trademark counsel	Specialist contractor
TEDx/public-speaking subject-matter advisors	Advisory basis

The easily underestimated role is **data operations**.

A beautiful event-search interface is useless if “Applications Open” is wrong.

Customer research program

Before full development, interview at least four groups separately:

Cohort	Recommended interviews	What to learn
Credible experts who want a TEDx opportunity	10	Research behavior, frustration, willingness to pay
Former or currently selected speakers	10	Real workflow, organizer expectations, preparation pain
Speaking/communication coaches	5 to 8	Coaching workflow, software gaps, client management
Former/current TEDx organizers	5 to 8	Data accuracy, common applicant mistakes, ethical boundaries

Do not use organizer interviews to obtain “inside tricks.”

Use them to understand process, quality and compliance.

Key questions should include:

How did you discover events?

How many event sites did you inspect?

How did you know applications were open?

What did you save in spreadsheets?

What changed after you were selected?

Where did your speech drafts live?

How many full rehearsals did you do?

How did you get feedback?

What claims were fact-checked?

Which parts required a human coach?

What happened to the talk after publication?

What professional outcome were you hoping the talk would produce?

What would you have paid to eliminate the most frustrating part?

Concierge validation before building a large crawler

A strong validation experiment would manually curate perhaps 200 relevant upcoming events in initial target markets.

For each event, researchers record:

- TED.com event,
- organizer website,
- date,
- public application status,
- application deadline,
- application URL,
- theme,
- major eligibility requirements,
- last verification date.

Then recruit 30 to 50 target users.

Let them create an Authority Profile and receive a personalized opportunity shortlist manually assisted by the team.

Measure:

> Did they save opportunities?
>
> Did they return?
>
> Did they submit legitimate applications?
>
> Did alerts change behavior?
>
> Was opportunity intelligence more valuable than writing AI?
>
> Would they pay $19, $29, or $39 monthly?

This tests the key assumption without first building a global ingestion system.

Ideal first customer

The best first customer is probably **not** someone whose only credential is wanting to become a motivational speaker.

A stronger early adopter looks like:

42-year-old consultant
15 years in organizational psychology
Published research or established methodology
Regular LinkedIn audience
Has spoken at industry conferences
Has three possible ideas but is unclear which is TEDx-appropriate
Has money but little time
Cares about reputation
Wants thoughtful feedback rather than a generated speech

That user is more likely to value the complete platform.

The product onboarding should therefore qualify for **idea readiness**, not social status.

Go-to-market

The strongest free acquisition asset is likely an accurate opportunity layer.

Potential acquisition loops include:

Search-driven event intelligence

A user searches for speaker application information about a particular event and finds a current verified status page.

The page must clearly identify its source and independent status.

Free Idea Test

The expert submits a one-sentence idea.

The product returns:

Idea versus biography
Idea versus service pitch
Evidence readiness
Likely content risks
Questions still unanswered

No false “TEDx acceptance score.”

Free Baseline Rehearsal

Upload a three-minute recording and receive a useful analysis.

Orai and Yoodli already use accessible/free entry points in communication coaching, which suggests users in this category are accustomed to trying the experience before subscribing. [34]

Partnership distribution

Good channel partners include:

- executive coaches,
- author communities,
- professional associations,
- speaker trainers,
- PR consultants,
- personal-brand agencies,
- leadership programs,
- business schools and executive education,
- consultant communities.

The partnership message is not:

> "We get your clients TEDx talks."

It is:

> "Give your clients a structured system for researching legitimate opportunities, developing evidence-backed ideas, practicing important talks and extending their thought leadership."

Product metrics

The north-star metric should **not** be TEDx acceptance rate because selection is outside the product's control.

A better north star is:

> **Talk projects reaching a meaningful next milestone each month**

Milestones can include:

`Qualified opportunity → application submitted → selected → script approved → full rehearsal completed → talk delivered → talk published → amplification campaign launched → inbound opportunity`

Supporting metrics should include:

Area	Metric
Acquisition	Visitor to account conversion

Area	Metric
Activation	Authority Profile completed
Activation	First qualified opportunity saved
Activation	First idea thesis completed
Research	% opportunity records recently verified
Research	False open-application rate
Research	Watchlist-to-application conversion
Application	Application completion rate
Writing	Evidence coverage of substantive claims
Writing	Content-risk flags resolved
Practice	Rehearsals per active talk per week
Practice	Full-run completion rate
Practice	Runtime variance improvement
Practice	Objective delivery metric change
Revenue	Free-to-Pro conversion
Revenue	Annual versus monthly mix
Revenue	AI cost per paying user
Retention	90-day active retention
Expansion	Users creating second non-TEDx project
Marketing	Published-talk campaigns launched
Outcome	Qualified speaking inquiries recorded
Safety	Unsolicited-pitch attempts discouraged
Data quality	Application status correction rate

A particularly important data-quality KPI should be:

Percentage of opportunity records with recent source verification

The business fails if users stop trusting deadlines.

Recommended activation definition

A user should be considered activated when they complete **three actions**, not merely when they create an account:

1. Complete an Authority Profile.
2. Save at least one qualified, source-verified opportunity.
3. Create an Idea Thesis.

For selected speakers:

1. Enter event details.
2. Import or create the current talk.
3. Complete one baseline rehearsal.

For post-talk users:

1. Add the publication.
2. Create the authority page.
3. Launch at least one campaign asset.

This lets analytics reflect the user's lifecycle state.

Primary business risks

Risk	Severity	Recommended response
TED/TEDx trademark or affiliation confusion	High	Neutral company branding, prominent independent-product disclosure, trademark counsel
Product perceived as pay-to-play TEDx access	Critical	No guaranteed placement, no organizer-access sales, no preferential submission
Monetized TEDx-specific coaching conflicts with TED rules	Critical	Legal review, written clarification where possible, keep core TEDx compliance functionality free
Application information becomes stale	High	Provenance, timestamps, automated rechecking, human QA
Scraping conflicts with site policies	High	Respect terms/robots, source public data appropriately, use organizer submissions and human verification
AI writes inauthentic applications	High	Coach Mode default, organizer-specific AI policies, authorship controls
Hallucinated fact-checking	High	Evidence links, source quality labels, no “verified” status without underlying evidence
Users mass-apply	Medium	Fit-first design, no auto-submit, quality limits
Sensitive recordings exposed	High	Encryption, deletion controls, security program

Risk	Severity	Recommended response
TEDx-only churn	High	Expand to broader speaking and authority lifecycle
Generic AI competitors copy practice metrics	High	Compete on workflow, data, evidence and lifecycle, not filler counts
Social amplification creates trademark misuse	Medium	Controlled templates and clear branding guidelines
Data acquisition becomes labor-intensive	Medium	Organizer claim portal, structured extraction, verification queues

The strongest final product concept

The most defensible version of this company is not:

> **“AI that writes your TEDx talk.”**

That would be easy to copy, risky in terms of authenticity, and poorly aligned with how TED says speakers should be selected.

It is also not:

> **“A database of TEDx organizer emails.”**

That conflicts with the public-application process and would encourage behavior TED explicitly discourages. [1]

And it is not:

> **“Another AI speech coach.”**

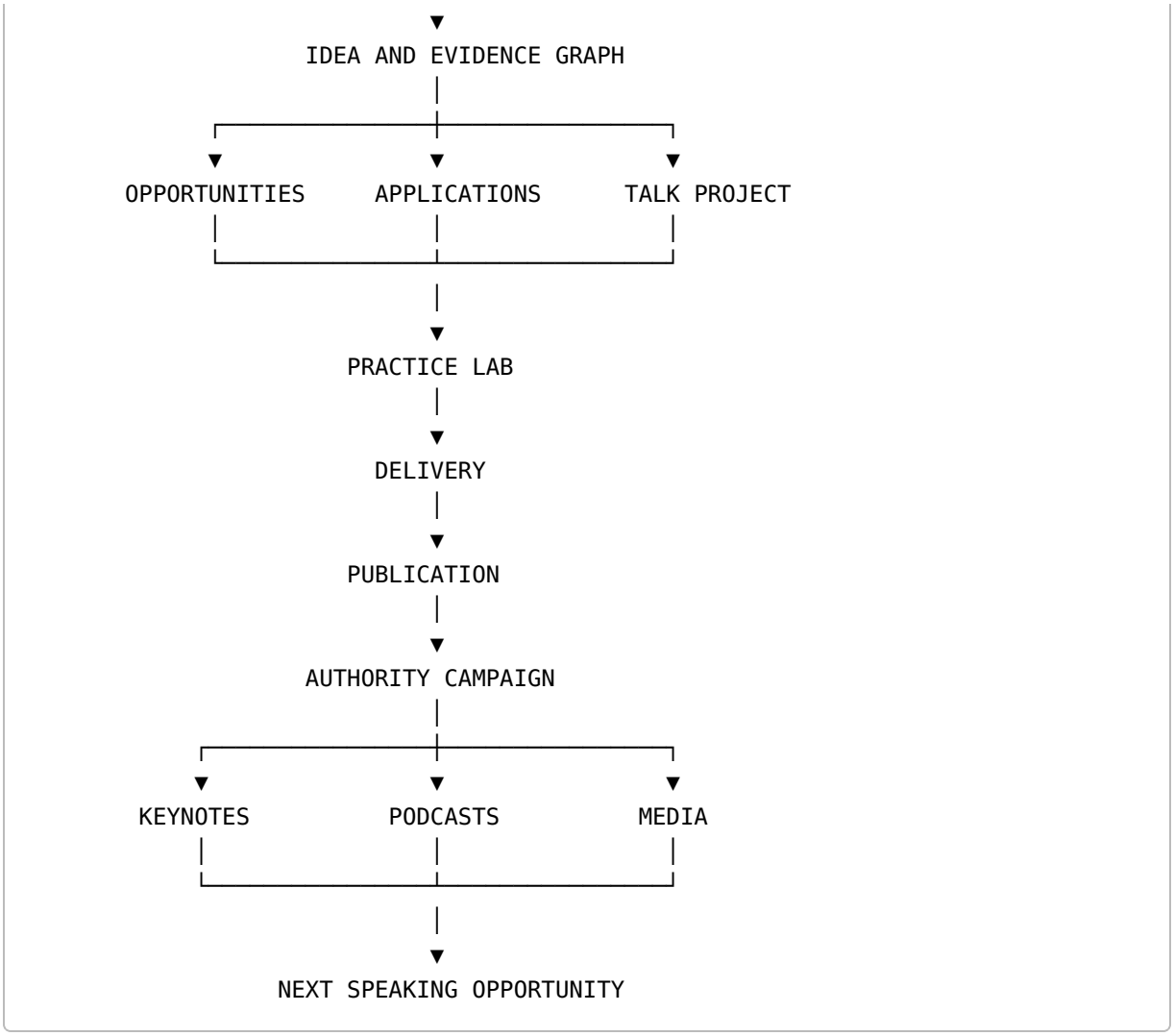
Yoodli, Orai, Poised and VirtualSpeech already compete aggressively in that category, including at relatively low individual price points. [25]

The stronger product is:

> **An independent authority and speaking workspace that helps credible experts identify legitimate opportunities, turn expertise into evidence-backed ideas, manage the complete talk-development process, practice with measurable feedback, and build lasting professional value around their ideas.**

The product architecture can then be summarized as:

```
                    AUTHORITY PROFILE
                           |
```



That creates a business with three important qualities at once.

It is **useful before selection**, because event research and idea qualification are difficult.

It is **useful during preparation**, because writing, evidence management and rehearsal require substantial repeated work. TED's own preparation guidance describes speaker development as rigorous, iterative and often extending across months. [20]

And it remains **useful afterward**, when the speaker wants the idea to become part of a larger body of professional thought leadership rather than a one-day speaking achievement.

That last transition is what turns the concept from a niche TEDx utility into a scalable professional-development platform.

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